

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

Toronto, Canada • +1 (416) 856-1276 • saber.ayatollahi@gmail.com • www.linkedin.com/in/sayatollahi

SUMMARY

Candidate for Manager, Investment Structure Management with ~7 years coordinating cross-functional teams through complex analytical and operational deliverables for institutional investors. Supports investing, Finance, Operations, and advisory partners through transaction-related workflows, governance documentation, and post-close maintenance – drawing on multi-asset analytics at Moody's Analytics, IFRS transformation delivery at EY, and pension ALM advisory at Ortec Finance. CFA charterholder; dual MSc; deploys AI tools to streamline analytical workflows and drive continuous improvement in operational processes.

CORE SKILLS

Cross-functional coordination (Finance, Legal, Operations, external advisors) • Transaction workflow support and closing project management • Governance documentation and institutional controls • Multi-asset institutional investment analytics • Operational process design and continuous improvement • Quarterly reporting and senior-stakeholder communication • AI tools (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) for workflow automation • Python analytics pipelines; Excel (Advanced) • CFA charterholder; dual MSc (Financial Modelling, Engineering)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Assistant Director, Modelling Services | Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Cross-functional Transaction & Analytical Support

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios (\$5-25bn per engagement; ~\$50bn cumulative) – coordinate review across internal modelling, product, and client-facing teams prior to each production release.
- Serve as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders to resolve structural and methodological complexities across fixed income, derivatives, and multi-asset mandates.
- Translate quantitative outputs into committee-ready narratives for senior stakeholders covering exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities.

Governance, Controls & Ongoing Maintenance

- Operate within Moody's formal model-governance framework – independently review assumptions, escalate outputs lacking economic defensibility, and maintain review-trail documentation consistent with institutional control standards.
- Prepare analytical summaries for quarterly stakeholder reviews covering interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and portfolio sensitivities – supporting visibility into operational and risk metrics.

Process Innovation & AI-Enabled Workflows

- Led design and delivery of an enterprise multi-asset cash-flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios – replacing a manual spreadsheet workflow with a scalable, auditable platform.
- Re-engineered recurring analytical workflows from spreadsheets into Python pipelines with embedded logging and auditability controls, delivering measurable continuous improvement in accuracy and cycle time.
- Deployed agentic AI tools (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) to automate code generation, validation scaffolding, anomaly detection, and documentation – reducing development cycle time by an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist | Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to an enterprise analytics platform – coordinated timelines, milestones, and pre-go-live activities across internal and client stakeholders.
- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and Moody's Product Owners and developers – scoped requirements into structured development requests and tracked implementation timelines through go-live.

- Transitioned all assigned client accounts from a legacy Calypso environment to the PFaroe PM platform, validating model outputs post-deployment.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant, IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation | Toronto, Sep 2021 – Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients – aligned regulatory requirements with system implementation, financial-reporting, and governance frameworks.
- Coordinated cross-functional delivery across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone planning, implementation materials, and governance documentation.
- Contributed to IFRS 17 advisory product offerings and go-to-market collateral, supporting methodology development and client-facing pursuits.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant, Asset-Liability Management & Risk | Toronto, Feb 2019 – Sep 2021

- Delivered ALM studies and Strategic Asset Allocation advisory for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors – analyzed funding ratios, duration alignment, and long-horizon balance-sheet exposures across multi-asset mandates.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform – including risk decomposition, attribution, and near-optimal frontier analysis to test the robustness of allocation recommendations.
- Led the onboarding and ALM study for the University Pension Plan (UPP) – a three-plan jointly-sponsored pension merger – on a team of three building and validating the model capturing all Funding Policy dynamics; evaluated duration, currency, inflation, and leverage overlay strategies.
- Presented findings to investment committees at pension-fund clients and coordinated with internal and external advisors across multi-stakeholder engagements.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) – CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling – Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) – Western University, 2016